

USER DOCUMENTATION

ACMS Dashboard

User Guide & Operating Manual

Document	User Guide
System	Access Control Management System
Organisation	NASTP
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1. About This Guide

The Access Control Management System (ACMS) Dashboard is the monitoring and analytics layer over NASTP's existing access-control database. It shows who holds a card, who is on site, where every card request has reached, and how those numbers are trending — without anyone needing to open SQL Server.

This guide is written for the people who use the dashboard day to day: security staff at the gate, the card printing desk, managers who want the numbers, and the administrator who manages accounts. It assumes no technical background. If you are setting the system up or maintaining it, read the **ACMS Technical Documentation** instead — it covers installation, configuration and troubleshooting.

1.1 What ACMS does and does not do

ACMS reads from and writes to the same database the existing card system uses. It is a **window onto that data**, plus a small number of actions — checking a visitor in or out, blocking a card, moving a card request forward. It does not replace the physical readers at the gates, and it does not print cards itself.

1.2 Conventions used here

- **Bold** marks something you click or type.
- A *role* is the permission level attached to your login. Some screens and buttons only appear for certain roles.
- Screens are referred to by the name that appears in the left sidebar.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Signing in

1. Open the dashboard address in a modern browser — Chrome, Edge or Firefox. Internet Explorer is not supported.
2. Enter your **username** and **password** and press **Sign in**.
3. You will land on the Dashboard. Your name and role appear in the top-right corner.

If you cannot sign in

After five failed attempts the account locks itself as a security measure. Ask your administrator to reset it — they can do this from the Admin screen in under a minute. If you have simply forgotten the password, the administrator can issue a new one; nobody, including the administrator, can read your existing password.

2.2 Roles and what each one can do

Every account has exactly one role. The role decides which buttons you see. If an action described in this guide is missing from your screen, it is almost certainly a role restriction rather than a fault.

Role	Can view	Can change
Viewer	Every screen except Admin	Nothing. Read-only throughout.
Security	Every screen except Admin	Check visitors in and out; issue, block and reactivate cards; verify card requests.
Printer	Every screen except Admin	Mark card requests as printed.
Admin	Everything, including Admin	All of the above, plus creating and managing user accounts, editing employee records, and running the analytics refresh.

2.3 Finding your way around

The left sidebar is grouped by what you are working with, not by which database table it comes from:

- **Overview** — the Dashboard.
- **Personnel** — everything about staff: Employees, Card requests, Personal RFID.
- **Visitors** — everything about visitors: Visitor log, Visitor RFID.
- **System** — Admin (administrators only).
- **Help** — this guide, the FAQ, and the technical documentation.

The top bar carries the menu toggle for narrow screens, the notification bell, the light/dark switch, and your account menu. The glowing circle in the bottom-right corner opens **Ask ACMS**, the plain-English assistant, from any screen.

3. The Dashboard

The Dashboard answers “what is happening right now, and how does that compare with the last few weeks?” Everything on it is live: the numbers are read from the database each time the page loads, and the activity feed updates itself without a refresh.

3.1 The four headline cards

Card	What it counts	Where it comes from
Total Employees	Every registered smart-card profile, active or not.	The employee profile table
Active Visitor Cards	Visitor passes that are switched on and not blocked. This counts cards , not people.	The visitor pass inventory
Visitors On Site Now	Visits with no checkout recorded yet. This counts people , not cards.	The visitor log
Pending Staff Requests	Card requests that have not been printed yet, at any stage.	The card request workflow

Why “Active Visitor Cards” and “Visitors On Site Now” are usually different

They deliberately measure different things. A card is a physical object that gets reused; a visit is an event that happens once. A pass sitting unissued in a drawer is an active card with nobody holding it, and a visitor checked in without a pass being switched on is a person on site with no active card. Click **Visitors On Site Now** to see exactly which of the two situations applies to each row — the breakdown separates them for you.

3.2 Opening a number to see what is behind it

Every number on the Dashboard is clickable. Clicking a card or a coloured tile opens a panel with three parts:

1. **The total**, with a **How this is counted** button. Opening that shows the exact database query behind the figure — so if the dashboard and a direct database query ever seem to disagree, you can see in seconds which filter each one applied.
2. **A breakdown chart**. Each bar is a category. Click a bar to narrow the list below to just that category; click it again to clear.
3. **A searchable list** of the individual records that make up the number. Section 4 covers searching it.

3.3 The five coloured tiles

Below the charts sit five tiles covering the areas that are checked most often. They behave exactly like the headline cards — click to open.

Tile	Breaks down by
Active Staff Cards	Card category
Deactivated Staff Cards	Reason — security blocks are separated from routine withdrawals
Pending Printing	How long each request has been waiting
Pending Approval	How long each request has been waiting
Today's Visitors	Visiting company

3.4 Charts

- **Card activity dynamics** — cards submitted against cards printed, day by day.
- **Request funnel** — of the requests *submitted in the selected period*, how many reached verification and how many reached printing. The percentage underneath is the share that made it all the way to a printed card. Because it follows one set of requests from start to finish, it can never exceed 100%.
- **Card status** — active cards against pending requests.
- **Visitor traffic** — entries and exits over time.

Reading the funnel correctly

The line under the funnel names the exact set of requests it describes, for example “Requests submitted between 13 Jul and 12 Aug, tracked to their current stage.” A card printed this month but submitted last month is counted in *last month's* funnel, because that is when it entered the process. The daily bar chart above works differently — it records each event on the day it happened.

3.5 Time range, refresh and export

- **Today / 7 / 30 / 90 days** changes the window every chart uses. The four headline cards are always “right now” and do not follow it.
- **Export** offers two formats. **Spreadsheet (CSV)** downloads the underlying figures and opens straight in Excel. **Printable report (PDF)** opens your browser's print dialog with the charts included — choose *Save as PDF* as the destination.
- **Refresh** re-reads everything immediately. The timestamp at the bottom of the page shows when the data was last pulled.

3.6 The live activity feed

The **Live activity** panel streams check-ins, checkouts, card blocks and request approvals as they happen, with no refresh needed. The pill in its corner shows the connection state: **Live** means events are arriving; **Reconnecting** means the link dropped and is being re-established automatically; **Offline** means the server is not reachable. The connection recovers on its own, including after the server restarts or your laptop wakes from sleep.

4. Searching and Filtering Records

Every drill-down list uses the same search bar, so learning it once covers the whole application.

4.1 The search box

Typing in the search box matches across **every** text column in the list at once — name, CNIC, card number, designation, company, remarks, whichever of those the list contains. Matching is partial and ignores capitalisation, so **ahm** finds both Ahmed and Bilal Ahmed.

Narrowing the search to one column

The **in** dropdown beside the search box lists every searchable column. Choosing one restricts matching to that column alone — useful when a common word appears in several places and you only care about one.

4.2 The Filters panel

Pressing **Filters** opens two further controls:

- **A status dropdown** whose options change with the list. On Deactivated Staff Cards it separates security blocks from routine withdrawals; on Visitors On Site Now it separates people holding a valid pass from those with no pass recorded.
- **A date range** — a **from** and a **to** field. Both ends are inclusive, so a range ending on 12 August includes everything that happened on 12 August. Filling only one end leaves the other open.

The date being filtered is named on the control itself, because it differs by list — activation date for active cards, deactivation date for deactivated cards, check-in time for visitors, submission date for pending requests.

4.3 Combining filters

All the controls narrow the same set together, and they combine with the breakdown chart. So you can click the **Lost or stolen** bar, set the date range to last month, and type a designation — and get exactly the cards matching all three.

Everything currently applied appears as a removable chip under the toolbar, so no filter can be left switched on invisibly. The **Reset** button clears them all at once, and the footer reads “Showing 8 of 24 (filtered from 112)” so you always know whether you are looking at a subset.

4.4 Sorting

Click any column heading to sort by it; click again to reverse. Lists open sorted by their date column, newest first.

5. Personnel Screens

5.1 Employees

The register of everyone holding, or entitled to hold, a NASTP staff smart card. Search by name, CNIC or service number, and click a row to open the full profile — designation, contact details, company, card expiry and card history.

Administrators can edit a profile from here. Everyone else has read-only access. Photographs, fingerprint enrolment data and scanned documents are stored in the database but are deliberately never displayed or exported by this dashboard.

5.2 Card requests

A staff card moves through three stages, in order:

Stage	What happens	Who can act
Submitted	The request is raised against an employee's CNIC and waits for checking.	Security, Admin
Verified	The details have been checked and the request is cleared for printing.	Security, Admin
Printed	The physical card has been produced and the request is closed.	Printer, Admin

Filter by stage to see only what needs your attention. The two **Pending** tiles on the Dashboard are shortcuts into the same data, grouped by how long each request has been waiting — which is the quickest way to spot something that has been stuck.

5.3 Personal RFID (staff cards)

The staff card register: one row per issued card, showing the holder, the card number, whether it is active, and its access level.

Blocking a card

1. Find the card and press **Block**.
2. Choose a reason from the list — lost or stolen, security incident, employment ended, expired, damaged, policy violation, or other.
3. Add a short note explaining the circumstances.
4. Confirm. The card is deactivated immediately, an entry appears in the live feed, and everyone with the relevant role is notified.

Blocked is not the same as deactivated

A **block** is a deliberate security action and always carries a recorded reason. A card handed back on resignation is simply **withdrawn** — also deactivated, but not a security event. The Dashboard's Deactivated Staff Cards tile shows both together, because that matches what a direct database query returns; use the status filter inside it to see the security blocks on their own.

Reactivating a card

Press **Reactivate** and give a reason. The original block reason and note are kept in the card's remarks — reactivating never erases history.

6. Visitor Screens

6.1 Visitor log

One row per visit. A visitor who comes three times appears three times — this is a history, not a contact list.

Checking a visitor in

1. Press **Check in**.
2. Enter the visitor's CNIC, name, company and contact number.
3. Enter the pass number you are physically handing over. **Do not skip this field** — see the warning below.
4. Save. The visitor appears immediately in Visitors On Site Now and in the live feed.

Checking a visitor out

Find the open visit and press **Check out**. The exit time is recorded and the pass is released for reuse. Until this is done the visitor stays counted as being on site, however long ago they actually left.

Always record the pass number

The visit log and the pass inventory are linked by the pass number. If a check-in is saved without one, the dashboard can still show the visitor as present but cannot tell which pass they are carrying — the row will appear under **No pass recorded** in the Visitors On Site Now breakdown. The same applies to a forgotten checkout: it leaves a visitor counted as on site indefinitely and keeps their pass tied up.

6.2 Visitor RFID (passes)

The pass inventory: one row per physical pass, showing whether it is active, whether it is blocked, when it was last issued and when it was last returned. Security staff can activate, block and release passes from here.

Because passes are reused, this list stays roughly the same size over time while the Visitor log grows continuously. That is expected.

7. Ask ACMS — the Plain-English Assistant

Ask ACMS answers questions about the access-control data in ordinary English. It reads the database, works out the query, runs it, and explains the result — no SQL required.

7.1 Using it

Click the glowing circle in the bottom-right corner of any screen. Type a question and press Enter, or click one of the suggested questions to start.

Questions that work well

- How many employees are registered?
- How many visitors are currently on site?
- How many card requests are still waiting to be printed?
- Which RFID cards are blocked?
- How many visitors checked in this month?
- What is the card request conversion rate?

Getting better answers

- Say **staff cards** or **visitor passes** rather than just “cards” — the two are separate populations.
- Ask one thing at a time. Compound questions are more likely to be misread than two simple ones.
- Give a time frame if you want one: “this month”, “in July”, “in the last 7 days”.

7.2 What it will not do

The assistant can only read, never change anything. It is additionally blocked from reaching photographs, fingerprint data, scanned documents, home addresses and login credentials — those restrictions are enforced by the database itself, not just by the assistant, so no phrasing of a question can get around them.

If a question is refused

A refusal means the query the assistant generated touched something outside its permitted area — usually a table or column it is not allowed to read. Rephrasing more specifically, or naming the screen you are thinking of, generally works. If a reasonable question is refused repeatedly, note the exact wording and report it; refusals are logged.

7.3 Chat history

The conversation is kept for the length of your session and is tied to your account. Signing out clears it, so the next person to use the same browser cannot see your questions.

8. Notifications, Appearance and Accessibility

8.1 The notification bell

The bell in the top bar collects the events relevant to your role — visitor check-ins and checkouts, card blocks, requests moving stage. A count appears while any are unread. Opening the panel groups them by day; **Mark all read** clears the count. Notifications are stored per account, so switching users on a shared computer does not carry them over.

8.2 Light and dark mode

The sun/moon switch in the top bar toggles the theme, and the choice is remembered on that computer. Both themes are contrast-checked to WCAG AA, so neither is harder to read than the other.

8.3 Keyboard and screen readers

- **Tab** and **Shift+Tab** move between controls; **Enter** or **Space** activates the focused one.
- **Escape** closes any open dialog, panel or menu.
- Focus is trapped inside dialogs while they are open and returns to the control you came from when they close.
- A **Skip to main content** link appears on the first Tab press.
- Tables carry proper column headers and sort states, so screen readers announce them correctly.
- If your system is set to reduce motion, animations are disabled automatically.

9. The Admin Console

Visible to administrators only.

9.1 Managing accounts

Action	Effect
Create user	Adds an account with a username, email, full name, CNIC, role and initial password.
Edit	Changes name, email or role. Usernames are permanent.
Deactivate	Blocks sign-in immediately without deleting the account, so the audit history stays intact. Reversible.
Reset password	Issues a new password. The existing one is never displayed, because it is not stored in a readable form.

9.2 Refreshing the analytics

The trend charts are built by a summarisation job that runs automatically every hour. **Run ETL** triggers it immediately — useful before a review, or after loading data in bulk. It is safe to run as often as you like: it rewrites the summary rows rather than adding to them.

9.3 Password rules

- At least 8 characters
- At least one uppercase letter
- At least one digit
- At least one symbol
- Five failed sign-in attempts lock the account

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Numbers and reports

Why do “Visitors on site now” and “Active visitor cards” show different numbers?

They count different things. One counts visits with no checkout recorded; the other counts physical passes that are switched on. A pass sitting unissued is active with nobody holding it, and a visitor checked in without a pass number recorded is on site with no pass linked. Click **Visitors on site now** — the breakdown labels each row so you can see which case applies.

The dashboard shows a different count from the one I get querying the database directly.

Open the metric and press **How this is counted**. It displays the exact query the dashboard used, which you can run yourself and compare. The commonest cause is a narrower condition — for example, security blocks are a subset of all deactivated cards.

Why is a filtered count lower than the tile said?

A filter is applied. The footer of the list reads “Showing X of Y (filtered from Z)”, and every active filter appears as a chip you can remove. **Reset** clears them all.

Why did the funnel percentage change when I changed the date range?

The funnel follows the requests *submitted* in the window you selected, through to whatever stage they have reached now. A different window is a different set of requests, so a different percentage is expected.

Can the funnel ever go above 100%?

No. It tracks one set of requests from start to finish, and printed requests are always a subset of submitted ones.

What is the difference between the Export options?

Spreadsheet (CSV) downloads the underlying numbers and opens in Excel. **Printable report (PDF)** opens the browser print dialog with the charts included — choose *Save as PDF* as the destination.

Cards

What is the difference between a staff card and a visitor pass?

A staff card belongs to one employee, is issued after a card request is approved, and lasts for years. A visitor pass is handed out at the gate, returned the same day, and reissued to somebody else tomorrow. They live in separate registers because they behave completely differently.

A card is deactivated but not showing under blocked cards. Why?

Blocking is a security action with a recorded reason. A card handed back on resignation is withdrawn, not blocked. Both appear under Deactivated Staff Cards; use the status filter inside it to see only security blocks.

Can I undo a block?

Yes — press **Reactivate** and give a reason. The original block reason stays in the card's remarks permanently.

Who can block a card?

Security staff and administrators.

Visitors

I forgot to check a visitor out yesterday. What now?

Check them out now. The exit time recorded will be the moment you press the button, so add a remark noting the real departure time. Until this is done they stay counted as on site and their pass stays tied up.

I checked someone in without a pass number. Does it matter?

Yes. The visit and the pass are linked by that number, so without it the system cannot tell which pass the visitor holds. The row appears under **No pass recorded**. Edit the visit and add the number as soon as you can.

Can the same pass be issued to two visitors at once?

It should not be. If two open visits share a pass number, one of them is a missed checkout.

Access and accounts

A button I need is missing.

Almost certainly a role restriction rather than a fault — see the role table in section 2.2. Ask your administrator if you need a different role.

My account is locked.

Five failed sign-in attempts lock it. An administrator can unlock it from the Admin screen.

I forgot my password.

An administrator issues a new one. Nobody can retrieve the old password — it is not stored in a readable form.

Why can I not see photographs or fingerprint data?

By design. Biometric data, scanned documents and home addresses are blocked at the database level for every dashboard user and for the assistant. This dashboard is for monitoring and analytics, not for identity document retrieval.

Ask ACMS

My question was refused for security reasons.

The generated query touched a restricted table or column. Rephrase more specifically, and say **staff cards** or **visitor passes** rather than just “cards”. If a reasonable question keeps failing, note the exact wording and report it.

Does the assistant need an internet connection?

Not necessarily. It prefers an online model for quality but falls back automatically to a model running on the local machine. Answers may take a little longer offline, particularly the first one after the server starts, while the local model loads.

Can the assistant change data?

No. It is restricted to read-only queries, enforced by the database account it uses rather than by the assistant's own behaviour.

Can other people see my questions?

No. History is tied to your account and is cleared when you sign out.

Display and performance

The live feed says Reconnecting or Offline.

The connection to the server dropped. It retries automatically and recovers when the server is reachable again — including after a server restart or after your laptop wakes from sleep. Everything else on the page keeps working; only the live updates pause.

A tile shows a dash instead of a number.

That figure could not be loaded. Press **Refresh**; if it persists, open the tile — the panel will show the underlying error.

A time looks several hours out.

All timestamps are stored in UTC and converted to your computer's local time zone for display. If a time looks wrong, check the computer's clock and time-zone setting first.

Which browsers are supported?

Current versions of Chrome, Edge and Firefox. Internet Explorer is not supported.

11. Glossary

Term	Meaning
CNIC	Computerised National Identity Card number. The unique identifier for a person throughout the system.
Staff card / Personal RFID	A smart card issued to an employee, valid for years.
Visitor pass / Visitor RFID	A temporary card issued at the gate and returned the same day.
Card request	The workflow that produces a staff card: submitted, then verified, then printed.
Blocked	A card deactivated as a deliberate security action, with a recorded reason.
Withdrawn	A card deactivated routinely, for example when handed back on resignation.
Drill-down	The panel that opens when you click a number, showing the records behind it.
ETL	The hourly job that summarises raw records into the figures the trend charts use.
Funnel	The submitted / verified / printed progression of one set of card requests.
Role	The permission level on your account: Admin, Security, Printer or Viewer.
UTC	Coordinated Universal Time. Times are stored in UTC and displayed in your local zone.

12. Getting Help

1. Check the FAQ in section 10, or the same FAQ inside the application under **Help**.
2. If a number looks wrong, open it and press **How this is counted** before reporting it — that usually explains the difference.
3. For access problems, contact your ACMS administrator.
4. For installation, configuration or error messages, see the **ACMS Technical Documentation**.

Reporting a problem

Include the screen name, what you clicked, what you expected, what actually happened, and the time it occurred. The time matters — it lets the matching server log entry be found quickly.